The Door

Marketing, what families get, and how entry works - agenda for Jenna, 20 October 2026

Jenna meeting - the door: marketing, what families get, and how entry works

Purpose: agree how the Launch Pad is offered to Vibrant Life families, decide the three things only you and Wes can decide, and name who writes the six missing pieces.

Not on this agenda: the programme itself. The three books are built, reviewed and printed. This is entirely about the door.

Documents to have open: `42-promotion-and-the-not-shown-wall.pdf` (the wall and the timeline), `44-the-familys-path.pdf` (the funnel, with a HAVE/MISSING column), `40-the-first-conversation.pdf` (the entry process in detail).

A. Decisions that unblock the door

1. The price

No Launch Pad document names a number. The family's path document calls it *"the second question every family asks."*

Yours and Wes's. Nothing else on this agenda moves without it. Unblocks: the January letters, the access statement, the Family note, the come-see-the-room evening.

2. The 2027-2028 term dates and breaks

Every date in all three books is projected from this year's calendar, and the books say so out loud. A family needs real term dates, breaks, and the last day.

Unblocks: the year calendar a family reads, and it corrects three printed books.

3. The Unveiling date

It sits outside the morning grid, an evening with families. The design asks for it fixed by the end of Session 4, in December, so a family rearranging a shift or flying a grandmother in has five months.

Recommendation: set it when the term dates are set, in the same sitting.

4. Who writes the six missing pieces

Missing	What it is	Shortest version
What it costs	A number, plainly	One line, from A1
The access statement	What one guide can hold, what they cannot, who we point you toward	Exists as a working draft. Five blocking items
What a Tuesday actually looks like	One page, hour by hour	The grid exists inside the internal year plan. Lift it
The year calendar	Term dates, breaks, the last day	One page, from A2
The FAQ	College, a diploma, sports, what if my kid hates it, what if we move, can they do this and part-time school	One page
A learner-facing page	Everything else is addressed to a parent. Nothing is written to the sixteen-year-old	One page

Recommendation: the Tuesday page and the FAQ do the most work for a family and are a morning's writing between them.

5. The oversubscription method

Target is five or six, ceiling seven. If more than seven fit, what happens is undecided and unowned.

Needed before the January letters, not before the pilot.

B. Things to tell you, where nothing is being asked

1. The access statement will read as the school's

It is a Launch Pad document, but families will read it as Vibrant Life's position on access, disability, and what a room can hold, **because the school does not have one of its own.** You and Wes should hear that before it publishes rather than after. It is still a working draft with five blocking items, so this is a heads-up and not a review.

2. The marketing position is the opposite of normal, on purpose

Ten things are never shown in any outreach, post, page, poster, letter or talk. No interior work as content. No before-and-after. No learner's story, image or voice. No outcome promises or alumni metrics. No re-contacting a graduate for a testimonial. No urgency or scarcity.

> *"Only seven seats" is a fact when a family asks and a lever when it leads. It never leads.*

What may be shown freely: the design, **the refusals as the feature they are**, the room empty, the guide as herself, the honest limits, the price and the exit, and the printed books.

The strongest asset is the one most programmes would never hand over: **a parent can read the entire teaching book, every page.**

3. Two structural commitments that cost money or people

A **second adult at every admission conversation**, so a learner's no is never said only to the person they would disappoint. And a **funded interpreter** where a household's first language is not English, with no learner ever interpreting their own admission conversation and no family member pressed into it.

C. The timeline, so the clock is visible

When	What
Now to Nov 2026	Access statement, Family note, the wall, fit signs published. **Nothing happens before these**
~3 weeks from go	The pilot morning. Not a promotion event and not shown
Jan 2027	Letters to families with a learner turning 16. Printed books available. An invitation, with no deadline
Feb 2027	Come see the room, one evening, repeated once if asked
Feb to Mar 2027	First conversations. **Before April**, because the baby is due in spring
Apr 2027	The learner's own yes. Written replies to every family

When	What
May 2027	Family note countersigned, waitlist named
Aug 16, 2027	Origin opens. Target 5 to 6, ceiling 7

The invitation order: current Vibrant Life families whose learner turns 16 first. The Compass already plants it through the Adventure-to-Launch-Pad page.

D. How entry actually works, in four stages

1. **The letter and the materials.** Everything in the HAVE/MISSING table above.
2. **The evening.** The settle, a choice game, the Table, the refusals read aloud. No learners present.
3. **The learner's conversation.** The family picks from a **mode menu** and the learner can change it on the day. It mirrors a guide day, so the learner meets the actual thing rather than an interview. Questions are grouped by eight fit signs, each read **yes or no, never ranked, never scored**. The guide's instruction: *one question, then stop, and count to five before saying anything else.*
4. **The family conversation, then the learner's own yes, a week later, alone.** Not the family's yes. Every family gets a written reply, and *"not this year" is never "not you."*

E. What we are asking for today

1. **The price.**
2. **Term dates, breaks, and the Unveiling date.**
3. **An hour on the six missing pieces**, and a name against each.

Everything else is built.

One flag: the Launch Pad one-pager from June still says "ages 15 to 18." The studio is 16 to 18 and the Stop Game set was corrected on 10-03. That page needs the same correction before it goes to anyone.